

CONTOUR

Point-and-Click Data Analysis at Scale

Visualize · Filter · Transform · Share

What is Contour?

Contour provides a point-and-click user interface to perform data analysis on tables at scale — enabling anyone to explore, visualize, and share insights without writing code.



Visualize

Create bar charts, line overlays, histograms, heatmaps, pivot tables, and more.



Analyze

Filter, aggregate, join datasets, and apply expression language for complex transforms.



Share

Publish interactive dashboards, export PDFs, or save results as new Foundry datasets.

Key Features



No-Code Analysis

Visualize, filter, and transform data without writing any code



Parameters

Parameterize analyses to switch between different data views easily



Export Results

Save analysis results as a new dataset for use in other Foundry tools



Analytical Paths

Organize complex analyses into structured, reusable paths



Interactive Dashboards

Create and share interactive dashboards with chart-to-chart filtering



Expression Language

Leverage Contour's expression language for advanced transformations

When to Use Contour

01

Data Not in Ontology

When some or all data isn't mapped in the Ontology layer — e.g., one-time uploads that won't be cleaned or reused.

02

Very Large Datasets

When you need to perform joins on 100,000+ objects or run aggregations across 50,000+ rows at scale.

03

Share as New Dataset

When you want to save and publish analysis results as a new Foundry dataset for use across other tools.

Core Concepts

Paths

Each analysis begins with a dataset. Add boards to visualize, filter, or transform data. Results can be saved as new Foundry datasets or used as starting points for other paths.

Boards

The key building blocks of Contour. Each board provides a different visualization or data manipulation action — filtering, charting, pivoting, joining, and more.

Dashboards

Build shareable dashboards from your analysis results. Supports chart-to-chart filtering, inline parameter references, full-screen presentation view, and PDF exports.

Parameters

Define reusable parameters (Date, String, Number) to easily switch between different data views. Parameters appear in dashboards and can accept multiple values.

Getting Started

1

Navigate to Your Files

Go to the Project & Files module and open Your Files.

2

Create a New Analysis

Select +New → Analysis from the action menu.

3

Add a Path

Click +Create a new path and select your dataset.

4

Add Boards

Use the toolbar to add Filter, Chart, Histogram, or other boards.

5

Build & Share

Add boards to a Dashboard and share with your team.

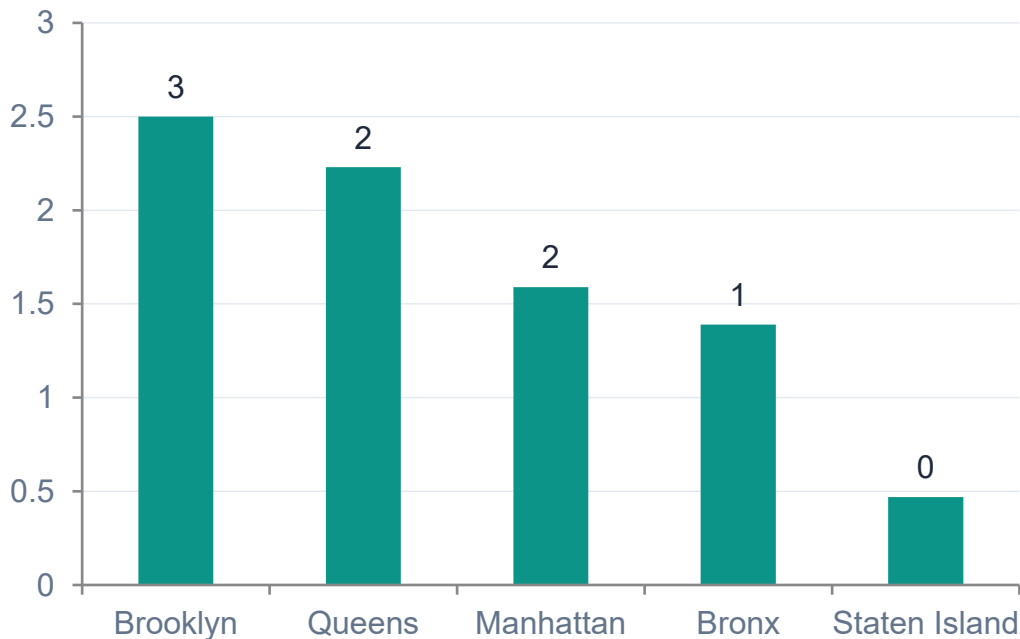


Pro Tips

- ▶ Perform all filtering in the first path for best performance.
- ▶ Use parameters to avoid duplicating paths for similar analyses.
- ▶ Save resulting datasets only when sharing across analyses.
- ▶ Only the Main Chart layer affects downstream data — overlays are presentation-only.
- ▶ Use Search mode (Ctrl+Enter) to quickly find boards.

Building Charts

NYC Population by Borough



How to Build a Chart

1. Add a Chart board from the toolbar
2. Set X-Axis (e.g., Borough) and Y-Axis (e.g., Sum of Population)
3. Click + Add Overlay for a line chart on a second axis
4. Under Format tab, adjust titles, colors, and number format
5. Add Segment by to break down bars by a category
6. Sort segments in Format → Format Series

Parameters

Switch between different data views without duplicating work

Types	Date · String · Number
Multi-Value	Enable 'Allow multiple values' for String and Number parameters — treated as arrays in Expressions
Usage	Reference in Filter board from dropdown, or in Expression board using <code>\$parameter_name</code> syntax
Override	Temporarily override values in the left sidebar — persists until page refresh, invisible to others
Suggested Values	Link to a dataset column for dynamic suggestions (up to 1,000 unique values)
Cross-Filter Groups	Group related parameters so selecting one filters suggestions for the others
In Dashboards	Parameters used by dashboard boards appear automatically for end-user interaction

Sharing & Collaboration



Contour Dashboard

Build interactive dashboards with chart-to-chart filtering, inline parameter references, full-screen view, and PDF export. Easiest way to share findings.



Notepad

Foundry's primary reporting tool. Add live-updating or point-in-time boards from Contour alongside content from Quiver, Code Workbook, and Object Explorer.



Direct Sharing

Share analyses via URL or by adding users directly. Shared analyses auto-update. Grant Editor role for collaborative editing with locking to prevent conflicts.

 **Collaboration Lock:** Only one editor at a time. If another user is editing, you'll see 'Document is locked.' Inactive editors are auto-released after 15 minutes.

Contour At a Glance

- ✓ No-code data analysis at scale
- ✓ Paths, Boards & Dashboards
- ✓ Flexible Parameters system
- ✓ Easy team collaboration
- ✓ Seamless Foundry integration

From Raw Data to Insights

Without Writing a Single Line of Code